

RELEVANCE

In Taylor County, 7,715 individuals are beneficiaries of the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP). Additionally, several factors highlight the need for enhanced Health Education:

- 35% of adults are classified as obese
- 25% of adults engage in insufficient physical activity.
- The quality of the food environment, assessed on a scale from 0 to 10 (with 0 representing the poorest value), stands at 6.8. This score reflects the percentage of the population that is low-income, lives far from grocery stores, and lacks reliable access to food.

Research indicates that SNAP recipients, along with other resource-limited groups, often have diets that do not align with current dietary guidelines, which may increase their risk for chronic diseases. Issues such as food insecurity, obesity, and limited access to healthy foods significantly affect this population and could adversely impact their health.

RESPONSE

The Better Living for Texans (BLT) program aims to help participants enhance their consumption of fruits and vegetables, increase physical activity, improve food security, and reduce the risk factors for chronic diseases such as obesity, diabetes, and cardiovascular disease.



The Program Area FCH/BLT Committee has identified Better Living for Texans curricula as an educational approach to address the need for health education in Taylor county.

Target Audience

The program focuses on SNAP-eligible adults and children residing in Taylor County.

Partnerships & Collaborators

The BLT program has expanded through valuable partnerships with organizations such as Foster Grandparents, Christian Job Corps, Faithworks of Abilene, Rose Park Senior Center, The Arbors at Rose Park, and Anson Park Senior Center, among others. These collaborations contribute to the program's growth and effectiveness.

Program implementation with low-income audiences was provided, at no cost to participants, through:

A Fresh Start to a Healthier You!

- a four-week program that promotes increasing fruit and vegetable intake, food safety, and food resource management.

Growing and Nourishing Healthy Communities

- a six-week program that teaches participants how to build gardens and grow fresh produce.

VALUE STATEMENT

Better Living for Texans

Better Living for Texans (BLT) is a nutrition education program funded by grants from the USDA's Food and Nutrition Service (FNS) and the Texas Health and Human Services Commission (HHSC). The program is designed to assist individuals in making healthier meals, enhancing physical fitness, saving money on groceries, growing their own food, and adopting improved food safety practices. Central to all BLT initiatives is a focus on nutrition, with a particular emphasis on preventing obesity.

1.5 MILLION

SNAP cases in the
State of Texas

7,715

SNAP cases in
Taylor county

162

individuals working toward
healthy lifestyle changes

SIMPLE MEXICAN SALAD



SERVINGS: 4



PREPARATION TIME: 15 MINUTES

EVALUATION STRATEGY

Better Living for Texans programs utilize pre- and post-surveys to assess and refine health education needs across Texas. These surveys are submitted through the Better Living for Texans portal, where they are analyzed at both the state and county levels to inform program improvements.

FUTURE PROGRAMMING

Future programming plans include:

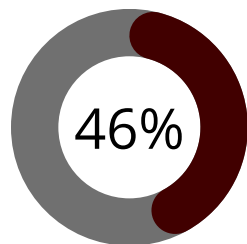
- **Growing and Nourishing Healthy Communities** Garden course for adults
- **Healthy Carbohydrates** nutrition course for adults
- **Walk Through Texas History: Fruit and Vegetable Route** physical activity and nutrition course for adults and youth
- **Choose Healthy** a nutrition course for middle schoolers
- **Steps to Health Color Me Healthy** physical activity and nutrition course for early childhood



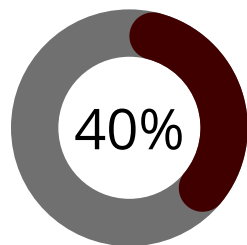
RESULTS

The impact of the Better Living for Texans program can be best demonstrated through our evaluation process:

A Fresh Start to a Healthier You!

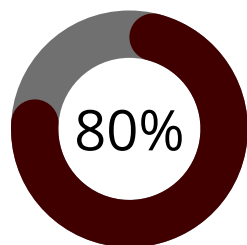


of participants reported filling at least half their plate with fruits and vegetables after completing the course, as opposed to only 27% prior to the course.



of participants reported meal planning before grocery shopping, which helps reduce grocery spending and food waste. An 11% increase from pre-survey results.

Growing and Nourishing Healthy Communities



of participants reported their knowledge of growing fruits and vegetables as "Good" or "Excellent" after completing the program. A 52% increase from information gathered prior to the course.

SUMMARY

Overall, the Better Living for Texans program is experiencing steady growth and making a significant impact. Each participant contributes to positive change by adopting healthier eating habits, increasing physical activity, and engaging in vegetable gardening. This collective effort is driving improvements in individual and community health.

"My kids only eat healthy snacks now, and they actually love it!!"

Margarita
A Fresh Start to a Healthier You!
Participant



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